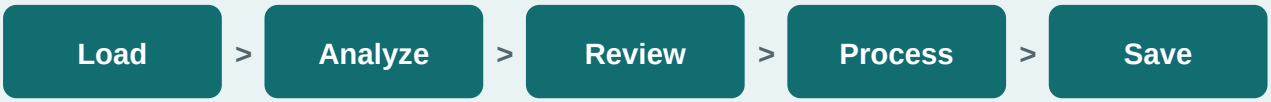
Start with the vocal

User manual / 1.08 Stable / 27 October 2026

Operation diagram / not a screenshot



What QQEasyTool does

QQEasyTool detects, marks and processes breaths in vocal audio, with manual regions for other sounds. Analyze detects Breath; mark Noise and Others as needed. Listen to Voice, Breath, Noise and Others separately, adjust breath level and EQ, and export aligned stems.

This is a full-function public release for feedback, without expiry or feature limits. Windows uses VST3. Mac packages include Apple Silicon VST3, Intel VST3 and Universal 2 AU. ARA requires a supporting host and its event/audio-extension loading command.

A five-step workflow

1. Load: read host audio through ARA, or capture input with Record in an ordinary insert.
2. Analyze: detect Breath. Switching ARA sources keeps the earlier job running.
3. Review: listen, refine boundaries and add Noise or Others regions.
4. Process: adjust Norm, Gain and EQ, then compare the sound.
5. Save: save the DAW project; use Export Stems for separate files.

Where to read next

Installation: page 2. ARA: page 3. Ordinary VST3 / AU: page 4. Region editing: page 5. Level and EQ: page 6. History, saving and export: page 7. Troubleshooting: page 8.

This manual covers UI version 1.08. Host metadata may show 1.0.8; it is the same version. Diagrams explain operations and are not screenshots.

Install the right format

Match the host architecture and replace the complete plug-in bundle.

Windows 10 / 11 x64

Download QQEasyTool-Windows-x64-1.08.zip. Save projects and quit all DAWs. Extract and copy the complete QQEasyTool.vst3 folder to:

C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3

Replace the old bundle, reopen the host and rescan. Do not copy only the internal binary or leave duplicate copies of the same format.

macOS 11 and later

Choose Apple-Silicon VST3 for a native arm64 host. Choose Intel VST3 for an Intel Mac or an x86_64 host running in Rosetta. Install one VST3 architecture matching the host.

VST3: ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3

For Logic Pro and other AU hosts, use AU-Universal, containing arm64 and x86_64. AU: ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components

Quit hosts before copying the complete QQEasyTool.vst3 or QQEasyTool.component bundle. Avoid duplicate user/system versions.

If macOS blocks loading

Packages are ad-hoc signed, not Apple Developer ID notarized. Only after verifying a trusted download, if quarantine prevents loading, type xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine followed by a space in Terminal, drag the installed bundle into Terminal, and press Return. Target only this plug-in; restart the host and rescan.

Downloads and upgrades

https://github.com/Ziqing-Gu/QQEasyTool/releases

GitHub automatic Source code (zip) / (tar.gz) files are not installable plug-ins. Complete-Source.zip includes corresponding source, ARA SDK and JUCE for rebuilding. Save a project copy before upgrading. Historical downloads remain available.

ARA: read host audio

Each source keeps its edits and analysis task when you switch.

Load and audition

Select a vocal audio event and load QQEasyTool through the host ARA / audio-extension command. A normal effect insert does not automatically enter ARA mode. Open the editor and use Load to read bound audio. Playback capture is unnecessary.

Use the DAW transport to play and stop. Clicking the waveform requests a host playhead seek; behavior depends on the host ARA playback controller. Follow keeps the view following playback.

Analyze and background jobs

Click Analyze. Queued means waiting for a worker. The time beside Analyzing is elapsed time, not estimated time remaining.

In 1.08, jobs belong to the source. Switching tracks or events, or closing the editor, keeps prior work alive. Results return to the original source without overwriting the newly selected one. Two low-priority workers are shared by instances of each plug-in; extra jobs queue.

Cancel explicitly cancels a job. Audio changes, host archive undo or manual region edits during analysis prevent an older result from overwriting newer state.

Selection, Reload and restore

When the host sends a new ARA event or track selection, the waveform, regions and parameters follow that source. Closing and reopening the editor is unnecessary.

Load / Reload preserves current edits and parameters. Internal Undo / Redo remains available during the current document session. Reopening a project restores saved edits; the complete undo chain does not survive an application restart.

Larger projects

Source caching uses memory proportional to active duration and channels. First loading, source reactivation or reloading long audio can take time. Audition Breath after analysis and manually correct false positives or missed breaths.

Ordinary VST3 / AU inserts

Capture input with Record, then audition and export through the host.

Capture audio

Insert QQEasyTool on the vocal track and place the DAW playhead at the required start. Click Record, then start DAW playback.

After the target passage, stop the DAW or click the plug-in Stop. Clear Recording clears the captured buffer. Save the project before recording again; a new Record clears the old analysis.

Analyze and edit

After capture stops, click Analyze. Inspect Breath regions when it finishes. Cancel stops analysis; Clear Analysis removes the region markings. Detection and region editing follow the same rules as ARA.

Ordinary inserts use the optimized analyzer too. The source-switching background continuity described on page 3 specifically applies to ARA.

Playback position and monitoring

The DAW controls playback. Clicking the waveform while stopped sets an internal audition position without moving the DAW main playhead. Starting playback then auditions from that internal position.

A later host seek or cycle wrap clears the audition offset and restores timeline alignment. Follow controls view scrolling. Wave changes display size only, not audio gain.

Save and restore

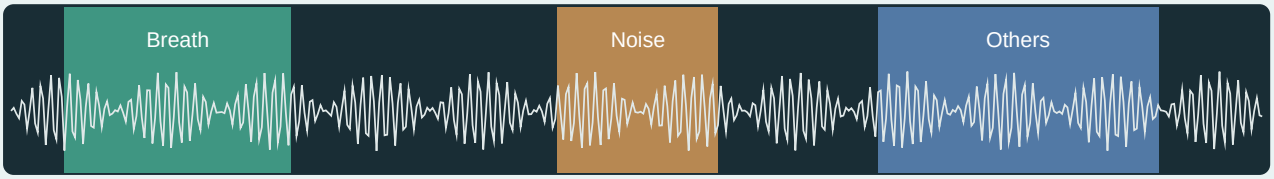
Captured audio and applied edits are saved with that plug-in instance in the DAW project. Separate ordinary insert instances keep their own audio and state.

Internal audition positioning does not move the project event. Check playback alignment and listen through the passage before a final export.

Edit regions and listen

Assign sounds to regions before deciding how much of each to retain.

Operation diagram / not a screenshot



Four sound categories

Voice is the remaining audio outside other regions. Breath contains detected or manually marked breaths. Noise is manually marked noise. Others holds other sounds needing separate treatment.

Right-click cycles Breath to Others to Noise to Breath. The last changed type becomes the next creation type. Legacy Sibilance regions map to Others; this release does not perform automatic sibilance detection.

Mouse and keyboard

Shift + left-drag creates a region of the remembered type and replaces the overlapping span. Draw at least about 20 ms.

Drag an edge to resize. Drag the body to move the region, constrained by neighboring boundaries.

Click to select. Delete / Backspace removes a mark. Double-click a processable region to open Region Adjust.

Vertical scrolling zooms around the pointer. Shift + scroll or horizontal scrolling pans the view.

Listen to each category

Voice / Breath / Noise / Others switches control the monitor mix. Listen to Breath alone to find mistakes, then add Voice to judge the natural result.

Turning off a monitor category does not delete regions. Select and Delete to remove a mark, or use Clear Analysis for all marks. A removed region returns to Voice.

Level, normalization and EQ

Global controls affect all Breath regions; local controls refine one region.

Global breath level

Breath Norm / Target normalizes each breath region by peak level, followed by global Breath Gain. Target is not a LUFS loudness value. Normalize uneven breaths first, then reduce Gain by ear.

Fade In / Out smooth region boundaries. Drag numeric values vertically, use the wheel or double-click to type. Hold Shift for fine changes. Alt + click restores that control default.

Global EQ and Region Adjust

Global EQ affects all Breath regions. Select a Breath or Others region and double-click or choose Region Adjust to edit its Gain and EQ. Noise does not offer this local Gain / EQ processing.

Global EQ / Region EQ switches scope. ON / EQ ON controls the relevant EQ. Clear clears the current EQ while preserving Gain. Loop auditions a loop; the DAW still controls play and stop.

EQ gestures

Double-click empty graph space to add a band. Drag a node for frequency and gain. Scroll over a node to adjust Q; Shift makes fine changes. Right-click a node to remove it. HP / LP provide high-pass and low-pass filtering; scrolling over a filter node changes slope.

Auto Apply and Apply

With Auto Apply on, changes commit automatically and the processed waveform updates. With it off, preview EQ first and press Apply to commit. Apply wanted changes before leaving the page, switching regions or saving; uncommitted previews may roll back.

EQ waveforms update in the background and may briefly retain the previous complete view while dragging. Sound and display updates can arrive at different times. On long audio, turn Auto Apply off and apply a group of changes together. Set as Default stores global defaults for new instances, excluding per-region Gain and EQ.

History, saving and stem export

Saved edits and undo history differ; audition before delivery.

Undo / Redo

Use the plug-in Undo / Redo buttons. Windows: Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Shift + Z. Mac: Command + Z / Command + Shift + Z. Give the plug-in keyboard focus; if the host intercepts shortcuts, click the buttons.

History covers regions, Gain, Norm, EQ and monitoring, separately by source. Up to 64 steps remain in the current processor / ARA document session, including Reload, source changes and editor close/reopen.

Hosts receive state-change notifications and can restore plug-in state, but native history entries and grouping depend on the host. A separate Cubase history entry for every edit is not guaranteed.

Save the project

DAW project saving stores applied regions and parameters, but does not serialize the entire internal Undo / Redo chain across application restarts. Save separate project versions at important stages.

Export Stems

Apply wanted edits, click Export Stems and choose a folder. The four aligned files are Voice.wav, Noise.wav, Breath.wav and Others.wav. Export uses the current source and region processing; monitor switches do not limit it to one stem.

Import all four at the same source start. If the source represents part of a host audio file, check the source range and start. For neutral splitting, disable Norm and EQ, set global and local Gain to 0 dB, and check the four stems together.

For one file containing the chosen monitor mix, leave the desired categories enabled and use DAW export. Listen through the full passage before committing the final render.

Troubleshooting and feedback

Check version, loading mode and the selected source first.

No waveform or Analyze unavailable

ARA: confirm event-extension loading and a bound selected source; use Load if needed. Ordinary insert: confirm Record captured audio and recording stopped. Read the status message.

The display looks unchanged after switching

Check that the host changed the ARA editor event selection, not only mixer focus. Version 1.08 includes selection refresh. If it still reproduces, note the host version, selection method, event lengths and exact steps.

Analysis takes time

Queued means workers are busy. Long files and many tracks affect waiting time. Sparse audio is faster in 1.08; quiet nonzero audio is still fully analyzed. Eight source WAV comparisons retained region types and boundaries, with native analyzer speedups of about 1.40-5.47x, not a fixed timing guarantee for every project.

Silence or an unexpected result

Check category monitoring and host mute, solo and routing. Confirm analysis belongs to the current audio. Files rendered as silence by an older version must be rendered again from original events; upgrading cannot recreate missing audio in an exported file.

Validation, maintenance and license

Windows automated regression and plug-in loading checks passed. Mac packages have build, architecture and signing checks. These do not establish acceptance in every Cubase / Studio One project or a real Mac DAW.

Future plug-in development focuses on QQEasyTool. DeBreath plug-in 1.29 may be its final release; downloads remain available. The standalone application is maintained separately.

https://github.com/Ziqing-Gu/QQEasyTool/issues. Include version, OS, host, loading mode and reproduction steps. Share only short audio you have permission to publish.

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